Trigger Library

Eleven public signals that a commercial building might be worth contacting now.

The rule that governs all of them

A trigger is an event, not a conclusion.

You saw a permit filed. You did not see their cleaning contract. You saw an address change. You did not see them fire their cleaner.

So: state the event, say what you do, and offer. Never state what you think the event means.

This isn't only about honesty, though it is that. It's that buyers can tell. *"I noticed you moved to Commerce Street"* is checkable and true. *"You probably need a new cleaner"* is a guess, and it puts you in the same category as everyone else guessing at them.

Two things every trigger needs

A source — where you saw it. **A date** — when it happened, not when you found it.

Without both, don't use it. In the tracker, a trigger missing either scores zero regardless of type. That's deliberate: unsourced triggers are how invented claims get into emails.

High value — score 5

1. New location opened

A second or additional site under a brand that already exists.

Where to find it: a new Google Business listing under an existing brand name · "now open" notices on their site · local business press. **Stays useful for:** 120 days. **Record it as:** *Google listing created 14 Aug, 5910 N MacArthur Blvd.* **You may say:** "Saw you opened the MacArthur location in August." **Do not say:** "You'll need a cleaner there."

2. New facility or first occupancy

A business occupying a building for the first time.

Where: occupancy and tenant-improvement permits on your county or city portal. Most publish these online and searchable. Some counties charge; most don't. **Stays useful for:** 90 days. **Record it as:** *TI permit #2026-04412 finaled 2 Aug, City of Plano.*

This is the strongest position in the industry. There's no incumbent to displace. It's a first purchase, not a switch. When you find one, work it first.

3. Move or relocation

An existing business at a new address.

Where: address change on their Google listing · "we've moved" notices · business journal "on the move" columns. **Stays useful for:** 90 days. **Why it lands:** they're buying everything at once — phones, internet, furniture, cleaning — and they want it off the list.

4. Property management change

A management company takes on a building, or a building changes hands.

Where: portfolio pages on management company websites (check them monthly and note what's new) · listing sites · signage changes you notice while driving. **Stays useful for:** 90 days. **Why it ranks at the top:** new managers review inherited vendors, and one relationship can expose several buildings. Of the eleven, this is the one that can produce the most work from a single conversation.

Medium value — score 3

5. Facilities or operations hiring

A role posted that will own vendor relationships.

Where: Indeed and LinkedIn. Search "Facilities Manager", "Office Manager", "Operations Manager", "Building Manager" in your area. **Stays useful for:** 90 days. **Two-edged:** a new facilities manager may review vendors, or may be too new to change anything for six months. Worth contacting. Not worth over-reading.

6. Renovation or reopening

Where: renovation permits · reopening announcements · temporary closure notices on their listing. **Stays useful for:** 60 days. **Note:** post-construction cleaning is a separate, usually larger, one-off job. Price it separately and say so.

7. Acquisition

Where: local business journals · press releases · state business registries. **Stays useful for:** 120 days. **Note:** vendor consolidation follows acquisitions in both directions. You might win or lose.

Low value — score 1

8. Headcount growth · 9. Funding or news · 10. Other

Real signals of activity, weak signals of a cleaning need. A company that raised money has more money. It does not have a dirtier office. Use these to break a tie, or as filler when your priority list is thin.

11. Review mentions cleaning

A public review mentioning dirt, restrooms, or cleaning.

This feels like the strongest signal here. It isn't, and it's worth explaining why.

A review saying the bathrooms were filthy does not tell you the business controls the cleaning contract. It doesn't tell you the reviewer was an employee rather than a customer, that the problem is current, or that anyone is looking for a new vendor. It's an inference about dissatisfaction, not an observation of a purchase window.

Use it only to break a tie between two accounts that both already have a real event.

Never quote it to a prospect. It reads as surveillance, and it asserts something about their current vendor you can't support. If they ask how you found them, "I saw your bad review" is not an answer that helps you.

What you may and may not say

You observed	You may say	You may not say
New Google listing	"Saw you opened the second location"	"You need a cleaner there"
Occupancy permit	"Saw the new building on Commerce cleared occupancy"	"You don't have a cleaner yet"
Address change	"Noticed you moved to Commerce Street"	"Your old cleaner won't follow you"
Portfolio addition	"Saw you picked up the Elm Street building"	"The inherited vendor won't work out"
Facilities job post	"Saw you're hiring a facilities manager"	"They'll want to replace their vendors"
Review complaint	*nothing*	*anything*

Everything in the right column is a conclusion.

Checking for triggers — a weekly habit

Thirty to forty minutes, once a week:

Check	Where	How often
Listing changes on your accounts	Google Business	Weekly
New permits in your area	County or city portal	Weekly
Facilities and ops job posts	Indeed, LinkedIn	Weekly
Management company portfolios	Their websites	Fortnightly
Business journal	Local press	Fortnightly

Freshness is the whole advantage. A 120-day-old permit is history, and mentioning it makes you look careless. Work the newest first. That is the one thing this method gives you that a bought list never will.